

Here's the full curation for **pen**, anchored to the passage phrase **"a fountain pen."** This is a much richer polysemy word than it first looks: writing instrument, animal enclosure, imprisonment, authorship, and several fixed expressions. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

PEN

1. Passage anchor

> "A present that I really liked was a fountain **pen** that my older sister gave me a few years ago."

Passage meaning

pen = an instrument used for writing or drawing with ink

筆；鋼筆類書寫工具

In the compound:

> **fountain pen**

= **鋼筆**

Practice

1. She gave me a beautiful **pen** with my initials engraved on it.

她送了我一支漂亮的**筆**，上面刻著我的姓名縮寫。

2. I still use the **pen** whenever I write something important.

每當我要寫重要的東西時，我仍會使用那支**筆**。

Core meanings of PEN

2. pen — writing instrument

= an instrument containing or using ink for writing or drawing

筆；墨水筆

Examples

1. Can I borrow your **pen**?

我可以借你的**筆**嗎？

2. She wrote her name with a blue **pen**.

她用藍色**筆**寫下名字。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. pen and ink

= writing or drawing done using a pen and ink

****鋼筆與墨水；墨水筆畫****

Examples

1. The artist produced a ****pen-and-ink drawing****.

藝術家創作了一幅****鋼筆墨水畫****。

2. The sketch was done in ****pen and ink****.

這幅素描是用****鋼筆和墨水****畫的。

Types of pen

4. fountain pen

= pen whose nib receives liquid ink from an internal reservoir

****鋼筆；自來水筆****

This is the exact passage compound.

Examples

1. I prefer a ****fountain pen**** for handwriting.

我寫字時比較喜歡用****鋼筆****。

2. The ****fountain pen**** writes very smoothly.

這支****鋼筆****寫起來非常順。

5. ballpoint pen

= pen that transfers ink through a small rolling ball at its tip

****原子筆；圓珠筆****

Examples

1. Please use a black **ballpoint pen**.

請使用黑色**原子筆**。

2. He signed the form with a **ballpoint pen**.

他用**原子筆**簽了表格。

6. gel pen

= pen using thick, water-based gel ink

中性筆；**啫喱筆**

Examples

1. She likes writing with **gel pens**.

她喜歡用**中性筆**寫字。

2. This **gel pen** produces very dark lines.

這支**中性筆**寫出的線條很深。

Writing / authorship

7. pen — verb: write something

= write or compose a text, especially something literary or formal

撰寫；**寫作**

Examples

1. She **penned** a short article about education.

她**撰寫**了一篇短文談教育。

2. The song was **penned** by a young songwriter.

這首歌由一位年輕作曲人**創作 / 填寫**。

This is a major figurative verb sense.

8. pen a letter / article / book

= write or compose a letter, article, book, etc.

撰寫信件 / 文章 / 書籍

Examples

1. He ****penned a letter**** to his former teacher.
他****寫了一封信****給以前的老師。
2. She ****penned several novels**** during her career.
她在職業生涯中****撰寫了幾部小說****。

Usually more literary or journalistic than simply ****write****.

Authorship / writer identity

9. pen name

= name used by a writer instead of their real name
****筆名****

Examples

1. She publishes novels under a ****pen name****.
她以****筆名****出版小說。
2. Mark Twain was a ****pen name****.
Mark Twain 是一個****筆名****。

10. under the pen name...

= using a particular pseudonym as an author
****以.....筆名****

Examples

1. He wrote ****under the pen name**** Lewis Carroll.
他以 Lewis Carroll 這個****筆名****寫作。
2. She published poetry ****under a pen name****.
她以****筆名****發表詩作。

The pen as symbol of writing

11. the pen — writing / authorship as a symbolic power

= writing, writers, or written expression considered symbolically

****筆；文字；寫作的力量****

Most famous in expressions such as:

> ****the pen is mightier than the sword****

Examples

1. He chose the ****pen**** rather than political office.
他選擇以****文字 / 寫作****發揮影響力，而不是從政。
2. Writers have long used the ****pen**** to challenge ideas.
作家長久以來都透過****文字****挑戰觀念。

12. the pen is mightier than the sword

= ideas and writing can have more lasting influence than physical force

****筆勝於劍；文字的力量勝過武力****

Examples

1. The saying ****“the pen is mightier than the sword”**** emphasizes the influence of ideas.
****「筆勝於劍」****強調思想與文字的力量。
2. She believed that ****the pen was mightier than the sword****.
她相信****文字的力量勝過武力****。

Animal enclosure

13. pen — small enclosed area for animals

= fenced enclosure where farm animals are kept

****畜欄；圈；圍欄****

Examples

1. The sheep were kept in a ****pen****.
羊被關在****羊圈****裡。

2. The farmer opened the **pen**.

農夫打開了**畜欄**。

This is a completely separate concrete noun sense.

14. pigpen

= enclosure where pigs are kept

豬圈

Examples

1. The pigs returned to the **pigpen**.

豬回到了**豬圈**。

2. The old **pigpen** was repaired.

舊**豬圈**被修好了。

15. playpen

= small enclosed area where a baby or young child can play safely

嬰兒遊戲圍欄；遊戲床

Examples

1. The baby was playing in the **playpen**.

寶寶正在**遊戲圍欄**裡玩。

2. They put some toys in the **playpen**.

他們把一些玩具放進**嬰兒遊戲圍欄**。

Lexicalized extension of the enclosure sense.

Verb: confine animals / people

16. pen animals in / up

= put animals into an enclosure or restrict them to a small area

把動物圈起來；關進欄內

Examples

1. The farmer **penned the sheep in** for the night.

農夫晚上把羊**圈了起來**。

2. The cattle were **penned up** near the barn.

牛群被**圈在穀倉附近**。

17. pen someone in

= prevent someone from moving freely because space or obstacles surround them

把某人困住；堵住

Examples

1. The car was **penned in** by other vehicles.

那輛車被其他車**堵住，開不出去**。

2. The crowd **penned us in** against the wall.

人群把我們**擠困在牆邊**。

This extends the animal-enclosure meaning figuratively.

18. pen someone up

= keep someone confined in a small or restricted space

把某人關著；使困在狹小空間

Examples

1. The children had been **penned up indoors** all day because of the rain.

因為下雨，孩子們整天都被**困在室內**。

2. I hate being **penned up in an office** all day.

我討厭整天被**困在辦公室裡**。

Often figurative.

Prison / penitentiary slang

19. the pen — prison

Informal, especially American English:

= prison or penitentiary

****監獄；大牢****

Examples

1. He spent several years in ****the pen****.

他在****監獄****待了幾年。

2. The character had just got out of ****the pen****.

那個角色剛從****監獄****出來。

Informal/slang and lower priority.

Female swan

20. pen — female swan

= adult female swan

****雌天鵝****

Examples

1. The ****pen**** stayed close to the cygnets.

那隻****雌天鵝****一直靠近幼天鵝。

2. A male swan is called a cob and a female a ****pen****.

雄天鵝稱為 cob，雌天鵝稱為 ****pen****。

Established zoological vocabulary, but low priority for general learners.

Computing / stylus-like input

21. digital pen

= electronic stylus used for writing or drawing on a digital device

****數位筆；觸控筆****

Examples

1. She takes notes with a **digital pen**.
她用**數位筆**做筆記。
2. The tablet supports a pressure-sensitive **pen**.
這部平板支援感壓**觸控筆**。

22. pen input

= entering handwriting or drawing into a computer/device with a stylus
手寫筆輸入；觸控筆輸入

Examples

1. The software supports **pen input**.
這套軟體支援**手寫筆輸入**。
2. You can switch from keyboard to **pen input**.
你可以從鍵盤切換成**觸控筆輸入**。

Related forms

23. penned

Past tense / past participle of **pen**.

It can mean:

A. wrote

撰寫了

> She **penned** the article.

B. confined

圈住；困住

> The animals were **penned** inside.

Context is essential.

24. penmanship

= skill or style of handwriting

書法；書寫技巧；筆跡

Examples

1. His **penmanship** is beautiful.
他的**字跡 / 書寫技巧**很漂亮。
2. Good **penmanship** used to receive more emphasis in schools.
過去學校更重視良好的**書寫能力**。

25. penholder

= holder for a pen; historically can also refer to a dip-pen handle

筆架；筆桿

Lower priority.

High-value expressions

26. put pen to paper

= begin writing something

動筆；開始寫

Examples

1. I had the idea for weeks before I finally **put pen to paper**.
那個想法在我腦中好幾週後，我才終於**動筆寫下來**。
2. It is time to **put pen to paper**.
是時候**開始動筆**了。

Very relevant to the gift passage.

27. pen and paper

= traditional handwriting or written work rather than digital methods

****紙筆；筆和紙****

Examples

1. Sometimes I prefer ****pen and paper**** to a laptop.

有時我比起筆電更喜歡用****紙筆****。

2. She planned the idea using ****pen and paper****.

她用****紙筆****規劃這個想法。

28. by the stroke of a pen

= by signing or writing an official decision, often suggesting something changes very quickly through authority

****大筆一揮；一紙命令之下****

Examples

1. The rule could not simply disappear ****with the stroke of a pen****.

這項規定不可能靠****大筆一揮****就消失。

2. Thousands of records were changed ****by the stroke of a pen****.

數千筆紀錄因****一紙決定****而改變。

Formal/figurative.

Key contrasts

29. pen vs pencil

****pen****

= writes using ink

****筆；墨水筆****

****pencil****

= usually writes using graphite

****鉛筆****

Compare:

> write in **pen**
> 用筆 / 原子筆書寫

> write in **pencil**
> 用鉛筆書寫

30. pen vs fountain pen

pen
= broad category of ink-writing instrument

fountain pen
= specific pen using a nib and liquid ink reservoir
鋼筆

Every fountain pen is a pen, but not every pen is a fountain pen.

31. pen vs marker

marker
= pen-like instrument producing broad, usually strong lines
麥克筆 ; 記號筆

pen
normally produces finer lines and is used for ordinary writing.

32. pen vs stylus

stylus
= pointed tool for interacting with a touchscreen/tablet, often without traditional ink
觸控筆

pen
traditionally writes physically with ink, though **digital pen** overlaps with **stylus**.

33. pen vs write

pen as a verb means **write**, but it is stylistically different.

write

= neutral everyday verb

寫

pen

= more literary, formal, or journalistic

撰寫

Compare:

> She **wrote** a letter.

> 她寫了一封信。

> She **penned** a heartfelt letter.

> 她撰寫了一封充滿感情的信。

34. pen vs enclosure

The two major noun branches are completely distinct:

> writing **pen**

> → 筆

> animal **pen**

> → 畜欄 / 圈

Context normally makes the difference obvious.

Meaning map

Pen has two important historical/concrete branches that learners should keep separate.

Writing instrument

pen

→ **筆**

From this develop:

* fountain pen → **鋼筆**

* pen name → **筆名**
* pen something → **撰寫**
* put pen to paper → **動筆**
* penmanship → **書寫技巧**

Enclosure

pen
→ **畜欄；圈**

From this develop:

* pen animals in → **把動物圈起來**
* be penned in → **被困住**
* pen someone up → **把人困在狹小空間**

Separate established extensions include:

Prison slang

the pen
→ **監獄**

Zoology

pen
→ **雌天鵝**

Digital technology

digital pen
→ **數位筆 / 觸控筆**

The passage uses the ordinary writing-instrument branch inside:

> **fountain pen**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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pen — writing instrument	使用墨水書寫或畫線的筆
fountain pen	透過筆尖和內部墨水儲存系統供墨的鋼筆
ballpoint pen	透過筆尖小滾珠供墨的原子筆 / 圓珠筆

gel pen	使用凝膠墨水的中性筆	
pen — verb write	以較正式、文學或新聞式語氣表示撰寫、創作	
pen a letter/article/book	撰寫信件、文章或書籍	
pen name	作者代替真實姓名使用的筆名	
the pen — writing symbolically	文字、寫作或作者力量的象徵	
the pen is mightier than the sword	思想與文字的影響力可以勝過武力；筆勝於劍	
pen — animal enclosure	圈養農場動物的小型圍欄 / 畜欄	
pigpen	圈養豬隻的豬圈	
playpen	讓嬰幼兒安全活動的圍欄 / 遊戲床	
pen animals in/up	把動物關進圍欄、圈起來	
pen someone in	因周圍有障礙或人群而使某人無法移動 / 離開	
pen someone up	把某人長時間限制在狹小或封閉空間內	
the pen — prison slang	非正式指監獄 / 大牢	
pen — female swan	雌天鵝	
digital pen	用於電子裝置寫字或繪圖的數位筆 / 觸控筆	
pen input	使用數位筆在電子裝置上輸入文字或圖畫	
penmanship	手寫字的技巧、風格或品質	
put pen to paper	開始把想法寫下來；動筆	
pen and paper	傳統以紙和筆書寫的方式	
by/with the stroke of a pen	透過一次簽署或書面決定迅速造成重大改變；大筆一揮	

Passage recap

> “A present that I really liked was a fountain **pen**...”

Here:

pen = **an instrument used for writing with ink**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **筆**

* full compound: **fountain pen → 鋼筆**

Natural contextual translation:

我很喜歡的一份禮物，是我姐姐幾年前送給我的一支鋼筆。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

pen

= **an instrument used for writing or drawing with ink**

****筆；墨水筆****

The highest-value contrasts are:

> fountain ****pen****

> → ****鋼筆****

> ****pen**** a letter

> → ****撰寫一封信****

> animal ****pen****

> → ****畜欄 / 圈****

> ****pen**** someone in

> → ****把某人困住****

> ****pen name****

> → ****筆名****

In the passage, however, ****pen**** is completely literal: a physical writing instrument given as a meaningful gift.